

# KUTUMBA

*Families Growing in Krishna Consciousness*

## Children and Youth Formation Operating Model

Version 1.0 — 29 June 2026

*Draft for review by the KUTUMBA core team, local temple leadership, current North American ISKCON child-protection authority, insurer and Pennsylvania counsel.*

**Status: Design baseline — not yet authorized for launch**

## Document control

| Field                    | Value                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Document owner           | KUTUMBA Children and Safety Lead                                                                                                    |
| Curriculum authority     | KUTUMBA Curriculum and Philosophy Lead, subject to approved source hierarchy                                                        |
| Safety authority         | KUTUMBA Child Safety Team; may stop any activity immediately                                                                        |
| External review required | Local temple leadership; current ISKCON North America child-protection authority; Pennsylvania legal/insurance review               |
| Review cycle             | After each six-week cycle; formal annual review; immediate review after any serious incident                                        |
| Storage                  | Policy and curriculum may be stored in Git. Child records, clearances, medical data and incident records must not be stored in Git. |

### Scope boundary

KUTUMBA is a family-formation program, not a drop-off child-care service, school, therapy program or private mentoring network. Parents remain on site and retain primary responsibility. This boundary is operationally important and should not be weakened casually.

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## 1. Decisions and operating assumptions

### Recommended operating decision

Launch with one large, visible children's space divided into two activity zones and staffed by three screened adults. Do not create two closed classrooms unless four screened adults are present. This is simpler, safer and more realistic for a founding cohort of ten to twelve children.

- Parents attend the Friday program, remain on site and can be called into the child area immediately.
- The founding cohort has approximately ten to twelve children, mainly ages four through seventeen. Children younger than four remain with a parent; KUTUMBA does not provide nursery care at launch.
- The normal child-specific formation block is approximately forty minutes, followed by a twenty-minute family bhakti laboratory.
- KUTUMBA will use trained volunteers rather than paid child-care staff during the pilot.
- The program may later include festivals, outdoor activities and pilgrimages, but these replace the regular weekly program rather than add extra obligations.

### Non-negotiable launch decisions

- All adults with direct responsibility for children must be approved before service; goodwill, seniority or family friendship is not a substitute for screening.
- KUTUMBA should require all three Pennsylvania background checks for designated direct-contact adults, including the FBI fingerprint check, even when a ten-year-residency affidavit might legally substitute. This stricter rule removes ambiguity and costs little relative to the risk.
- No adult is ever alone with an unrelated child in a closed or hidden space, vehicle, digital conversation or mentoring relationship.
- A suspected abuse report goes directly to Pennsylvania ChildLine or emergency services. It does not wait for the Program Director, temple president, family council or internal investigation.
- Only designated trained adults manage formal correction. Other adults may prevent immediate harm, then hand the matter to the responsible adult and parent.
- Children are never punished for not singing, chanting, reciting, performing or displaying emotion. Participation is invited and scaffolded, not coerced.
- No public ranking of children, rounds, memorization, family practice, musical ability, school performance or material status.

## 2. Child-formation philosophy

**Formation goal.** Children should gradually understand who they are, know Kṛṣṇa through authorized stories and teachings, develop safe devotional habits, experience belonging, practise service, build character and become capable of making responsible choices. The program is not designed to produce polished performers or to create pressure for premature spiritual identity claims.

### Eight formation principles

- **Relationship before performance:** A child who feels safe, known and respected is more able to hear, participate and ask honest questions.
- **Experience plus meaning:** Stories, songs, instruments, worship, cooking and outdoor activities are paired with one clear philosophical meaning.
- **One theme across the family:** Parents and children study the same central theme at different levels, then apply it together.

- **Repetition without boredom:** Key prayers, verses and habits return through games, drama, art, call-and-response, service and family practice.
- **Choice within structure:** Children may choose between two appropriate activities or use a quiet reset space, but they may not create unsafe conditions.
- **Devotion without manipulation:** No guilt, fear, public shaming, forced disclosure, threats about karma or claims that ordinary misbehavior means Kṛṣṇa is displeased.
- **Material responsibility is not rejected:** Education, health, discipline, work skills and social responsibility are duties that can be connected to service.
- **Parents remain the primary daily teachers:** The Friday program supports the home; it cannot compensate for a home culture that contradicts the lesson.

### Standard child-session rhythm

| Minutes | Element                 | Purpose                                                            |
|---------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0–5     | Welcome and regulation  | Name check, visual schedule, settle bodies, assign small service.  |
| 5–12    | Story or discovery      | Concrete incident, prop, picture, short reading or demonstration.  |
| 12–20   | Meaning and questions   | One principle; discovery, understanding and application questions. |
| 20–32   | Active learning         | Game, drama, art, experiment, music or practical skill.            |
| 32–37   | Verse, prayer or recall | Short recitation with meaning; no forced solo performance.         |
| 37–40   | Closing and transition  | One child takeaway, reset room, reunite with family.               |

## 3. Age-band and staffing strategy

### Four developmental levels; two operational zones

| Level           | Typical ages | Learning mode                                                                     | Operational placement                                                                               |
|-----------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Parent-attached | Under 4      | Sensory participation with parent; no separate formal class                       | Remain with parent. Optional five-minute story corner only when parent is present.                  |
| Bāla            | 4–7          | Story, movement, imitation, concrete objects, short repetition                    | Younger activity zone.                                                                              |
| Junior Kiśora   | 8–10         | Retelling, classification, simple cause and effect, cooperative projects          | Older activity zone with differentiated task.                                                       |
| Senior Kiśora   | 11–13        | Reasoning, case studies, journaling, skill practice, discussion                   | Older activity zone; may receive extension challenge.                                               |
| Youth           | 14–17        | Text-based reasoning, honest questions, service projects, supervised facilitation | Older zone, selected parent sessions or separate visible table; never counted as adult supervision. |

### Grouping rules

- If a level has fewer than three children, combine it with the adjacent level and differentiate the output rather than creating a separate room.
- Use the same story and principle but vary the task: Bāla identifies and acts; Junior Kiśora retells and sorts; Senior Kiśora explains and applies; Youth evaluates and facilitates.

- A child may work one level up or down for a particular activity based on readiness, language, disability or emotional regulation. Placement is private and never described as promotion or demotion.
- Teens may occasionally join the parent discussion when the topic is appropriate and parents have been informed, but they still receive youth-specific reflection and safeguarding.

### Internal staffing standard

| Setting                         | Minimum screened adults  | Additional trigger                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| One visible hall with two zones | 3                        | Add a fourth adult if more than five children are under age seven or any child requires continuous individual support. |
| Two separate rooms              | 2 per room               | Do not split unless four screened adults are present. Teens do not count.                                              |
| Outdoor local activity          | 3                        | Add adults based on terrain, water, crowds, disability support and transport plan.                                     |
| Overnight activity              | Not part of launch model | Requires a separate policy, legal/insurance review and substantially stronger staffing.                                |

### What changes this model

A heavily preschool-aged cohort, drop-off attendance, more than twelve children, children requiring one-to-one care, regular transportation, overnight trips or a second site all require a new staffing and legal review. Do not stretch the founding model beyond its design.

## 4. Three-year learning progression

| Domain                       | Year 1 — Sambandha and belonging                                                   | Year 2 — Practice and character                                                               | Year 3 — Readiness, service and leadership                                                                     |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity and philosophy      | Soul and body; Kṛṣṇa; karma; rebirth; material nature; guru, sādhu and śāstra.     | Mind and senses; habits; association; offenses; qualities of a devotee; regulated practice.   | Study method; sambandha-abhidheya-prayojana; nāma and guru-tattva foundations; explaining without speculation. |
| Scripture and story          | Retell authorized stories and connect one clear principle.                         | Compare stories, identify choices and apply principles to home and school life.               | Read short passages, identify evidence and context, prepare a concise explanation.                             |
| Sādhana and worship          | Participate in kīrtana, prayer, prasāda, simple home altar and offering culture.   | Practise japa attention, basic etiquette, Tulasī, festivals and simple home-program roles.    | Plan and lead approved portions under supervision; understand limits and authorization.                        |
| Character and relationships  | Kind speech, truthfulness, cleanliness, responsibility, safe bodies and inclusion. | Self-control, apology and repair, digital/media boundaries, conflict and service reliability. | Servant leadership, confidentiality, feedback, accountability and protection of younger children.              |
| Service and practical skills | Setup, cleanup, serving, art, music and simple cooking tasks.                      | Own a recurring service, learn instruments, festival preparation and community care.          | Design a supervised service project, train a junior helper and complete tasks reliably.                        |
| Community and pilgrimage     | Temple belonging, festivals, cows, nature and holy places introduced respectfully. | Preparation, conduct, service and reflection during outings and yātrās.                       | Research, brief younger children, support logistics and produce a reflection or presentation.                  |

## Age-adjusted evidence

| Age level           | Expected evidence                                                                                                  |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bāla 4–7            | Recognizes, points, joins, dramatizes, repeats a short phrase, completes a concrete service with help.             |
| Junior Kiśora 8–10  | Retells sequence, answers why/how questions, sorts examples, recites with meaning, performs a task with reminders. |
| Senior Kiśora 11–13 | Explains principle in own words, applies it to a case, keeps a simple journal, performs service reliably.          |
| Youth 14–17         | Uses an authorized source, evaluates a case, names uncertainty, facilitates a short activity and accepts feedback. |

## 5. First six months: detailed child curriculum

The following eighteen active weeks align with the three curriculum cycles already defined in the KUTUMBA operating model. Off weeks remain complete off weeks. This child layer does not replace the full weekly facilitator pack developed in the separate curriculum workstream; it defines the age differentiation, safeguarding and evidence of learning.

### Cycle 1 — Identity and the human problem

#### Week 1 — We belong to KUTUMBA

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Establish safety, belonging, purpose and the expectation that families grow together rather than children being dropped off for entertainment.                                      |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.17–18; Bhagavad-gītā 9.14. Child meaning: hearing and chanting gradually clean the heart and help us remember Kṛṣṇa.                                          |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Create a family-tree leaf with one service each child can do. Practise the five child agreements with picture cards. Tour the room and identify safe adults, exits and reset space. |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Build a “What makes a strong KUTUMBA?” poster using hearing, chanting, service, kindness and responsibility. Discuss the difference between a community and a casual party.         |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Review the covenant, identify how youth can contribute without controlling younger children, and write one personal growth goal plus one service goal.                              |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Room setup and cleanup relay; learn where instruments, first aid, allergy list and attendance roster are kept without exposing private data.                                        |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Each family chooses one five-minute weekly practice and one act of service. Parent asks: “What helped you feel that you belong?”                                                    |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child can name two purposes of KUTUMBA, two safety rules and one personal service.                                                                                                  |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Do not use “we are one family” to blur boundaries. Community love does not authorize private access, secrets or parental replacement.                                               |

**Week 2 — I am not this body**

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Distinguish the changing body from the continuing self without devaluing the body or encouraging neglect of health.                                                     |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 2.13. Child meaning: the body changes from childhood to youth to old age, while the person continues.                                                     |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Use baby, child and adult picture cards. Pass a “same person, changing body” doll sequence. Draw “things my body can do” and “qualities of me that are not body parts.” |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Timeline activity: identify body changes and continuing identity. Discuss respectful differences in appearance, ability and culture.                                    |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Examine weak claims such as “the body does not matter.” Explain why spiritual identity increases responsibility to care for health and others.                          |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Mindful body gratitude and simple japa posture practice; clean and respectfully store mats and beads.                                                                   |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Parents share one childhood photo and one enduring value or devotional influence. Avoid comparison of appearance.                                                       |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child can explain in age-appropriate language that the body changes while the self continues.                                                                           |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Do not present disability, sickness or body size as karma punishment. Do not invite personal medical disclosure.                                                        |

**Week 3 — The soul is conscious and eternal**

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Introduce the soul as the conscious self and distinguish life from a machine through observation and authorized teaching.                                                                       |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 2.20 and 2.17. Child meaning: the soul is not born or destroyed and gives consciousness to the body.                                                                              |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Compare a glove with and without a hand. Move, speak and feel; then identify that a body needs the living person. Make a small light collage symbolizing consciousness.                         |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Glove/robot analogy plus limits: machines can move but do not become souls because we program them. List signs of a living person and ask what science can observe versus what śāstra explains. |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Discuss analogy limits and avoid pseudo-scientific claims. Write a three-sentence explanation using verse reference, analogy and caution.                                                       |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Quiet observation: “I am the observer of my thoughts and senses.” Short guided japa attention exercise.                                                                                         |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family uses the phrase “You are a person to respect, not a problem to fix” during one conflict.                                                                                                 |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child gives one property of the soul and uses the glove analogy without claiming the analogy proves everything.                                                                                 |



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| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Avoid graphic death discussion with younger children. Be prepared for grief questions and refer personal grief care to parents. |
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#### Week 4 — Human life is rare and purposeful

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Help children value human intelligence, responsibility and the opportunity for spiritual inquiry without insulting animals or other people.                |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.9.29; Bhagavad-gītā 7.19. Child meaning: human life gives a special chance to ask deep questions and choose service.                  |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Sort picture cards: eating, sleeping, protecting, learning, praying, choosing. Emphasize care for animals and the special human ability to ask “Who am I?” |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Design a one-day “use my human life well” schedule balancing school, health, family duty and devotion.                                                     |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Discuss wasted time, digital distraction and false urgency. Create one realistic attention boundary rather than an extreme vow.                            |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Book handling, reading setup and one-minute reflective silence before hearing.                                                                             |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family identifies one recurring time leak and replaces ten minutes with reading, chanting or service twice during the week.                                |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child names one human capacity and one responsibility that follows from it.                                                                                |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Do not frame school, sports or careers as useless. Teach responsible integration rather than withdrawal.                                                   |

#### Week 5 — Temporary things cannot give permanent happiness

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Recognize change and disappointment while appreciating legitimate material joys as temporary gifts rather than ultimate shelter.                              |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 2.14 and 8.15. Child meaning: pleasant and unpleasant conditions come and go; deeper happiness grows through relationship with Kṛṣṇa.           |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Ice-cube or bubble demonstration. Children name good things that do not last and make a “lasting treasure” box with love, service, knowledge and remembrance. |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Happiness meter case studies: new toy, praise, friendship, service, kīrtana. Distinguish temporary pleasure, healthy satisfaction and spiritual nourishment.  |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Challenge the false choice “material joy is bad.” Discuss gratitude without dependence and grief without denial.                                              |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Gratitude prayer followed by caring for shared materials rather than grabbing the best item.                                                                  |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Each family enjoys one simple activity and ends with gratitude and Kṛṣṇa remembrance, not guilt.                                                              |

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|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child identifies one temporary pleasure and one more durable source of meaning.                                         |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Do not minimize loss or tell a distressed child simply to detach. Emotional care comes before philosophical correction. |

### Week 6 — Cycle 1 integration: Who am I and how should I live?

|                                     |                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Consolidate identity, human purpose and temporary-versus-lasting happiness through cooperative presentation rather than competition. |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Review Bhagavad-gītā 2.13, 2.20 and 2.14.                                                                                            |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Group puppet sequence: body changes, soul continues, human life chooses service. Every child receives a small role.                  |
| <b>Kīśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Create a floor-map with stations and explain one concept at each. Teams rotate; no points or winners.                                |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Facilitate questions, identify overstatements and prepare a two-minute source-based summary for parents.                             |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Family gallery walk; children demonstrate verse meaning, room service and respectful question answering.                             |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Parents name one thing learned from a child and affirm effort, not performance quality.                                              |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Portfolio contains one drawing, one explained analogy and one service reflection.                                                    |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | No prizes for the best recitation, costume or presentation. Accommodate children who prefer a non-speaking role.                     |

## Cycle 2 — Karma, rebirth and material nature

### Week 7 — Actions have consequences

|                                     |                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Introduce karma as ordered consequence and responsibility without using it to blame victims or explain every hardship.            |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 3.9 and 4.17. Child meaning: actions create results; work offered in service does not bind in the same way.         |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Domino and seed demonstration. Sort actions into helpful, harmful and “need more information.” Practise repairing a small mess.   |
| <b>Kīśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Consequence chains from speech, screen use, study, food waste and service. Distinguish natural consequence from adult punishment. |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Study a case where outcomes are mixed or delayed. Explain why humans usually cannot calculate another person’s karma.             |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Clean a used area fully and connect service to responsibility rather than punishment.                                             |

|                                     |                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family chooses one action-consequence chain to improve and records what actually happened.                                                |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child can give one example of consequence and state that karma must not be used to blame someone who suffers.                             |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Never tell a child abuse, illness, disability or family crisis is deserved karma. This is both harmful and philosophically irresponsible. |

### Week 8 — Free will and responsible choices

|                                     |                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Show that conditioned choices are limited but meaningful; children can pause, seek help and choose a better response.           |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 18.63 and 6.5. Child meaning: guidance is given, and each person must choose responsibly.                         |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Traffic-light choice game: stop, think, choose. Use two acceptable options for common classroom situations.                     |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Decision tree for peer pressure, anger and media use. Identify what is controllable, influenceable and not controllable.        |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Discuss freedom versus impulse. Examine how habits, modes and social pressure affect choice without eliminating accountability. |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Practise a pause before beginning kīrtana or eating prasāda; choose one service role and complete it.                           |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Parent and child use the same three-step choice language once during the week.                                                  |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child can name a pause strategy and a safer choice in a realistic scenario.                                                     |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Do not promise that every good choice produces an immediate pleasant result.                                                    |

### Week 9 — Birth, death and changing bodies

|                                     |                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Explain reincarnation carefully through the changing-clothes analogy, with age-sensitive handling of death and grief.                    |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 2.22 and 2.13. Child meaning: as clothing is changed, the soul receives another body.                                      |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Use clean clothing on a doll. Focus on change and Kṛṣṇa's care. Allow a child to pass rather than discuss death.                         |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Sequence birth, growth, old age, death and rebirth using neutral cards. Compare the clothing analogy with its limits.                    |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Discuss what the verse teaches and what it does not tell us about a specific deceased person. Practise responding respectfully to grief. |

|                                     |                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Offer a flower or prayer in gratitude for those who care for us; no improvised memorial ritual.                                           |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Parents decide whether and how to connect the lesson to any family bereavement. The program does not raise private losses publicly.       |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child can explain the clothing analogy and state that we should care for living people and grieving families.                             |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Teachers review known bereavements beforehand. No graphic descriptions, fear-based hell narratives or claims about a person's next birth. |

### Week 10 — The three modes shape habits and environments

|                                     |                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Introduce goodness, passion and ignorance as influences on behavior and atmosphere, not fixed labels for people.                       |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 14.5–9 and 17.8–10. Child meaning: different qualities influence how we think, act and choose.                           |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Sort rooms or routines into calm/clear, restless/busy and dull/confused using pictures. Improve one environment together.              |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Analyze food, media, sleep and speech scenarios. Redesign a Friday-evening routine toward clarity and steadiness.                      |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Discuss mixed modes, context and the danger of labeling families or cultures. Create a one-week experiment with sleep, media or study. |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Mindful instrument volume, orderly setup and clean prasāda area as practical goodness.                                                 |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family changes one environmental cue—device parking, bedtime, reading space or morning preparation—and reviews impact.                 |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child identifies mode-like influences in a situation without calling a person “ignorant.”                                              |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Do not turn the modes into personality types, caste labels or moral superiority.                                                       |

### Week 11 — Māyā and the decorated prison cell

|                                     |                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Understand distraction and false identification while avoiding contempt for the world, family responsibilities or beauty.                   |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 7.14 and 2.62–63. Child meaning: material energy is difficult to overcome, but taking shelter of Kṛṣṇa changes our direction. |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Treasure-path game with attractive distractions. Children practise remembering the goal and asking for help.                                |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Phone-notification or advertising case study. Identify hook, feeling, action and consequence. Create a reminder of the real goal.           |

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Critique the “prison cell” analogy: the world is Kṛṣṇa’s energy and responsibilities remain real. Māyā means seeing and using things without connection to Kṛṣṇa. |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Japa focus lab with one respectful restart strategy when attention wanders.                                                                                       |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family sets one device-free devotional window and evaluates honestly rather than pretending perfect success.                                                      |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child names one distraction pattern and one way to reconnect with purpose.                                                                                        |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Avoid conspiracy thinking, fear of technology or teaching children to distrust ordinary education and society.                                                    |

### Week 12 — Cycle 2 family case-study night

|                                     |                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Apply karma, choice, rebirth, modes and māyā to realistic family situations without exposing private family problems.                         |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Review Bhagavad-gītā 3.9, 18.63, 2.22, 14.5 and 7.14.                                                                                         |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Picture cases: grabbing an instrument, refusing cleanup, wasting food and excluding a child. Act out stop-think-choose and repair.            |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Small-group cases: screen conflict, dishonesty, peer pressure, late homework and service avoidance. Explain consequences and better supports. |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Facilitate nuanced cases with competing duties. Identify source, principle, uncertainty and practical next step.                              |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Family teams complete one service under a time limit without comparing speed.                                                                 |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Each family chooses one case-study sentence to use at home: “What result will this choice create?”                                            |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Teacher notes whether the child can apply a principle rather than merely repeat a term.                                                       |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Use fictional composites only. Do not invite children to disclose parents’ conflicts or identify another family.                              |

## Cycle 3 — Kṛṣṇa, guru and the process of bhakti

### Week 13 — Who is God?

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Clarify basic features of the Supreme—source, controller, knower and well-wisher—while respecting that children may have questions or prior beliefs. |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 10.8 and 9.10. Child meaning: everything has its source in the Supreme, and material nature works under divine direction.              |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Source-chain activity: trace an object back through makers and materials. Use sun and sunshine carefully as an analogy for source and energy.        |

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Compare impersonal force, limited controller and personal Supreme. Identify what evidence comes from observation and what comes from śāstra.       |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Formulate questions about suffering, freedom and God without forcing simplistic answers. Practise saying “I do not know; let us check the source.” |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Care for a shared resource as Kṛṣṇa’s energy; gratitude prayer.                                                                                    |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family lists three things received rather than manufactured independently and offers thanks.                                                       |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child names two attributes of God and one honest question.                                                                                         |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Do not mock other religions or claim every complex theological question has a one-line answer.                                                     |

### Week 14 — Who is Kṛṣṇa?

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Introduce Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead through Bhagavad-gītā and age-appropriate authorized pastimes.                                                     |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 10.8, 7.7 and 4.9; Kṛṣṇa Book, selected early pastimes. Child meaning: Kṛṣṇa is the source, a person, and acts for the protection and joy of His devotees. |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Story with images: a safe, age-appropriate childhood pastime. Children identify Kṛṣṇa’s qualities and create a quality flower.                                           |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Evidence map: verse, quality, pastime and application. Distinguish Kṛṣṇa from an ordinary superhero.                                                                     |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Discuss avatāra claims and the need for śāstric authority. Prepare a concise answer to “Why do devotees call Kṛṣṇa Supreme?”                                             |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Learn respectful handling of Kṛṣṇa images and book materials; create a clean display.                                                                                    |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family reads or listens to one authorized Kṛṣṇa Book passage and names a quality, not only an exciting event.                                                            |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child identifies one quality of Kṛṣṇa and supports it with a source or story.                                                                                            |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Avoid confidential or romantic pastimes beyond age and curriculum authorization. Do not reduce Kṛṣṇa to entertainment.                                                   |

### Week 15 — Guru, sādhu and śāstra

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Teach how guidance works and how to distinguish authorized guidance from personality worship, secrecy or blind obedience.                                                                                               |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Bhagavad-gītā 4.34; Śrī Īsopaniṣad mantra 1 introduction; approved biographies of Śrīla Prabhupāda. Child meaning: approach qualified teachers with respect, inquiry and service, and verify through sādhus and śāstra. |

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Three-support stool: teacher, saintly community and scripture. Practise asking a respectful question and checking with a parent.                                                    |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Scenario sorting: good guidance, opinion, pressure, secrecy and unsafe instruction. Learn “A safe teacher never asks me to hide concerning behavior from my parent or safety lead.” |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Discuss authority limits, conscience, evidence and reporting. Read a short Prabhupāda incident showing service and inquiry.                                                         |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Book care, question-writing and respectful reception of a teacher.                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Parent invites one honest question and responds without ridicule; unresolved questions go to an approved source review.                                                             |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child explains the three checks and names a safe response to an adult who requests secrecy.                                                                                         |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | This week must include safeguarding language. Respect for guru never cancels law, parental responsibility, bodily boundaries or reporting duties.                                   |

### Week 16 — Śrī Caitanya and the holy name

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Experience congregational chanting as accessible devotional practice and understand mercy, participation and respectful kīrtana conduct.                          |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Caitanya-caritāmṛta Ādi-līlā 17.21 and standard Pañca-tattva and mahā-mantra practice. Child meaning: Śrī Caitanya spread chanting of the holy name for everyone. |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Story, call-and-response and rhythm walking. Learn when to play, when to stop and how to protect hearing.                                                         |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Map the saṅkīrtana process: lead, respond, listen, cooperate and remember meaning. Practise kartāla basics.                                                       |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Discuss authenticity versus performance culture, volume, ego and inclusion. Lead a two-minute approved chant under supervision.                                   |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Kīrtana response, instrument passing and respectful storage.                                                                                                      |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family conducts one short home kīrtana with simple instruments or clapping; no recording required.                                                                |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child participates safely and explains why devotees chant together.                                                                                               |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | No pressure to dance, sing solo or display ecstasy. Protect children with sensory sensitivity and hearing needs.                                                  |

### Week 17 — The nine processes of bhakti

|                |                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b> | Show that devotional service is broad and practical, allowing children to discover suitable ways to engage while keeping hearing and chanting central. |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24. Child meaning: hearing, chanting, remembering, serving, worshipping, praying, serving as a servant, friendship and full dedication are ways of relating to Kṛṣṇa. |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Nine-station picture walk with one simple action at each. Children choose a favorite and one unfamiliar process.                                                                               |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Match stories and services to the nine processes. Plan a balanced mini home program using three processes.                                                                                     |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Examine strengths and imbalances: activity without hearing, study without service, music without conduct. Design a service experiment.                                                         |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Rotating micro-labs: hearing, prayer, altar care, serving and friendship through inclusion.                                                                                                    |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family selects one process to strengthen for seven days and records one concrete action.                                                                                                       |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Child names several processes and gives a real-life example without ranking one child's preference above another.                                                                              |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | Do not allow “my process is better” identity or use service preference to avoid basic responsibilities.                                                                                        |

### Week 18 — Cycle 3 integration: Kīrtana, drama and family presentation

|                                     |                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Purpose</b>                      | Integrate Kṛṣṇa, guidance, chanting and the nine processes through a safe cooperative presentation.                                           |
| <b>Primary source and key verse</b> | Review Bhagavad-gītā 10.8 and 4.34; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24.                                                                              |
| <b>Bāla: ages 4–7</b>               | Short drama with narrator support, group chanting and nine-process picture cards. Non-performing roles include props, altar care and welcome. |
| <b>Kiśora: ages 8–13</b>            | Create and lead stations for parents. Every explanation must include one source reference and one practical example.                          |
| <b>Youth: ages 14–17</b>            | Youth host the sequence, manage time and invite questions while screened adults retain all safety and correction authority.                   |
| <b>Bhakti laboratory / sevā</b>     | Approved kīrtana, instrument care, presentation, prasāda serving and complete cleanup.                                                        |
| <b>Family home link</b>             | Family chooses one next-cycle practice based on actual capacity, not presentation enthusiasm.                                                 |
| <b>Evidence of learning</b>         | Portfolio includes one source-based explanation, one practical skill and one reflection on service.                                           |
| <b>Risks and facilitation notes</b> | No public awards, ranking, social-media pressure or forced costumes. Media consent is checked before any recording.                           |



## 6. Behavior expectations and positive correction

### Five child agreements

1. Safe body: hands, feet, instruments and objects are used safely.
2. Kind and truthful speech: no mocking, threats, gossip, slurs or deliberate exclusion.
3. Respect sacred spaces and materials: books, images, instruments, prasāda and worship items are handled carefully.
4. Follow safety directions promptly: stop, come back, lower volume, move away or get a parent when instructed.
5. Participate responsibly: join the activity, take an approved quiet reset, or ask for help; do not disrupt others' ability to learn.

### Positive correction ladder

6. **Connect and cue:** Use the child's name, calm proximity and a brief reminder of the agreement.
7. **Redirect:** State what to do, not only what to stop: "Keep the kartālas below your shoulders and play softly."
8. **Offer two safe choices:** Join the task in a simpler role or use the visible reset space.
9. **Brief reset:** Two to five minutes with a screened adult in visible space; no isolation, interrogation or humiliation.
10. **Parent support:** Parent joins, co-regulates or temporarily takes the child out of the activity.
11. **Activity removal for safety:** The child may stop that specific activity when risk remains. Prasāda, affection and basic belonging are never withheld.
12. **Private parent conversation:** Describe facts, triggers, supports attempted and next steps. Do not diagnose.
13. **Written regulation and safety plan:** Used when the pattern is repeated or significant.
14. **Temporary pause:** Used only when the program cannot maintain safety with available staffing; paired with a written return plan where feasible.

### Prohibited correction methods

- Physical punishment, painful restraint, rough handling or forcing a posture.
- Public humiliation, sarcasm, ridicule, group chanting of a child's mistake or comparing siblings.
- Threats involving Kṛṣṇa, guru, karma, hell, exclusion from the devotee community or parental disappointment.
- Withholding food, prasāda, bathroom access, medication, comfort or contact with a parent.
- Forced apology, forced confession, coerced eye contact or requiring a child to disclose private feelings publicly.
- Unapproved seclusion, closed-door "talks," private car rides or sending a child away with an unscreened adult.
- Treating ordinary developmental behavior, disability or sensory overload as spiritual failure.

## 7. Parent communication

| Moment           | Communication standard                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Before admission | Parent completes child profile, emergency/allergy form, media choices and a brief placement conversation. Parents receive the behavior and safeguarding policies. |
| Weekly           | One concise message: theme, verse/prayer, home prompt, materials needed and any schedule change. No child-specific information in the group thread.               |
| Minor concern    | Private factual conversation at pickup or within twenty-four hours. Include what happened, support attempted and whether follow-up is needed.                     |

| Moment                     | Communication standard                                                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Repeated concern           | Scheduled parent meeting with Children Lead and Safety Lead; written support plan if appropriate.                |
| Safety or medical incident | Immediate parent contact unless authorities advise otherwise or the parent may be implicated in suspected abuse. |
| Cycle review               | Private progress note: one strength, one next step and one realistic family practice.                            |

- Parents do not correct another family's child except to stop immediate harm. They notify the designated adult.
- The group chat is not a forum for complaints about a child, parent, marriage, diagnosis, school or spiritual practice.
- Teachers communicate observations, not labels. Say “left the activity four times and pushed when redirected,” not “aggressive,” “ADHD,” “spoiled” or “not devotional.”
- Parents must disclose information necessary for safety and access, but KUTUMBA does not demand medical histories unrelated to participation.

## 8. Safeguarding governance and reporting

### KUTUMBA Child Safety Team

- Minimum three screened adults: Safety Lead, Deputy and one additional member. Ideally they are not all from the same household and include both operational and parent perspectives.
- The Safety Lead may stop a class, outing, transport plan, volunteer assignment or media activity immediately. Program leadership cannot overrule the stop in the moment.
- The team maintains policies, verifies screening, arranges annual training, performs site checks, reviews incidents and liaises with the current ISKCON child-protection authority and local temple.
- The team does not investigate suspected abuse, mediate between alleged victim and alleged offender, seek confessions or promise confidentiality it cannot keep.
- If the Safety Lead is implicated or conflicted, the Deputy and external authorities receive the report directly.

### Reporting decision rule

#### Direct-report rule

When a mandated reporter has reasonable cause to suspect child abuse, the report is made directly to Pennsylvania ChildLine or the Child Welfare Portal. Internal notification follows; it does not replace or delay the report. Immediate danger is a 911 matter. The child does not need to prove abuse, and the volunteer should not investigate.

| Situation                                           | Immediate action                                                                                       | Internal action                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Immediate danger or serious medical emergency       | Call 911; provide first aid within training; secure other children.                                    | Notify Safety Lead and parent when safe and appropriate; document facts.                                                                        |
| Disclosure or reasonable suspicion of abuse/neglect | Mandated reporter makes direct ChildLine/portal report. Do not interview beyond minimal clarification. | Notify Safety Lead after the report unless conflicted; follow authority guidance; notify current ISKCON child-protection authority as required. |

| Situation                                       | Immediate action                                                         | Internal action                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Boundary breach without current abuse suspicion | Stop access, preserve messages or facts, notify Safety Lead immediately. | Risk review, parent communication as appropriate, volunteer suspension pending review, external consultation if threshold is uncertain. |
| Ordinary injury or behavior incident            | Provide care, involve parent, restore safety.                            | Complete incident/near-miss form; review pattern and prevention.                                                                        |

## Responding to a child disclosure

15. Stay calm and listen. Do not show shock, anger or disbelief.
16. Use minimal open prompts such as “Tell me what happened” or “What happened next?” Do not ask leading or repeated questions.
17. Do not promise secrecy. Say that you must get help from people whose job is to keep children safe.
18. Record the child’s words as accurately as possible after immediate safety and reporting actions.
19. Do not confront the alleged person, contact other families for corroboration or conduct a community meeting.
20. Do not automatically notify a parent when the parent may be implicated or notification could increase danger; follow authority guidance.

## 9. Volunteer screening and training

### Volunteer categories

| Category                   | May do                                                     | May not do                                                                           | Approval                                                         |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Visitor/guest              | Attend public family portions with parent supervision.     | Teach, supervise, transport, message or correct children.                            | No child role.                                                   |
| Occasional helper          | Prepare materials or serve prasāda in visible common area. | Be counted in ratio or have direct unsupervised contact.                             | Orientation and code acknowledgment.                             |
| Designated child volunteer | Teach or supervise within approved role.                   | Private mentoring, transport outside approval, independent discipline.               | Full screening, training and shadowing.                          |
| Child lead / safety team   | Lead program or safety function within scope.              | Investigate abuse or override reporting duties.                                      | Enhanced interview, references, role training and annual review. |
| Teen sevā assistant        | Support activities under direct adult supervision.         | Count as adult, correct children, handle check-out, medication or confidential data. | Parent consent, teen agreement and role briefing.                |

### Required screening for designated adults

21. Written application, government photo identification and role description.
22. Pennsylvania Child Abuse History Certification.
23. Pennsylvania State Police Criminal History Record Check.
24. DHS FBI fingerprint-based background check for every KUTUMBA designated child volunteer as an internal standard, even if a legal affidavit option is available.
25. Two references, with at least one from a setting involving responsibility or children and neither from the applicant’s household.
26. Structured interview covering motivation, discipline beliefs, boundaries, prior concerns, reporting duty and willingness to be supervised.

27. Current ISKCON CPO screening/clearance process where available and confirmation that no applicable ISKCON restriction exists.
28. Signed code of conduct, confidentiality agreement and seventy-two-hour self-disclosure obligation.
29. Two-session shadow period before independent assignment. Independent assignment still means two-adult practice, not working alone.

## Training curriculum

| Training                                                              | Before service                                                                | Refresh                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pennsylvania mandated-reporter recognition and reporting              | Required                                                                      | At least every three years or when law/process changes; annual scenario review. |
| Current ISKCON child-protection policy and reporting expectations     | Required                                                                      | Annual and whenever policy changes.                                             |
| KUTUMBA code, two-adult rule, media, transport and digital boundaries | Required                                                                      | Annual.                                                                         |
| Positive behavior support and de-escalation                           | Required                                                                      | Annual practice.                                                                |
| Emergency, first aid, allergy and evacuation procedures               | Required for all; CPR/first-aid certification for at least two adults on site | Drills twice yearly; certification per provider schedule.                       |
| Age-band teaching and authorized-source discipline                    | Required for teachers                                                         | Cycle preparation and observation feedback.                                     |
| Outdoor/trip module                                                   | Before participating in an outing                                             | Before each high-risk or new activity.                                          |

## 10. Two-adult, visible-space and transition practices

- At least two screened adults are present and able to observe every formal child activity. A teen, unscreened parent or remote adult on a phone does not count.
- Doors remain open or have unobstructed windows. No formal child activity occurs in bedrooms, basements without exits, storage rooms, parked vehicles or other hidden spaces.
- When only three screened adults are available, use one large visible hall with two zones. Do not put one adult alone in each of two rooms.
- One adult does not take a child to a separate room for correction. The visible reset area remains within sight of the group or another screened adult.
- Parents handle routine toileting. A volunteer may monitor the hallway. If an emergency requires entering a restroom, another adult is informed and remains nearby; the incident is documented.
- Headcounts occur at arrival, after every room or outdoor transition, before transport departure, on arrival and before dismissal.
- During transitions, one adult leads and one sweeps the space. Children are never told simply to “go find your parents.”
- Instrument, kitchen, candle, electrical, water, animal and outdoor hazards receive activity-specific supervision.

## Physical-space checklist

- Visible entry and exit; emergency exits unlocked and known.
- No exposed medicines, cleaning chemicals, knives, matches, cords or unstable furniture.
- Age-appropriate chairs and floor space; quiet reset area visible but not punitive.

- First-aid kit and emergency contacts accessible to adults, not children.
- Allergy and medical alerts accessible only to responsible adults.
- Sacred items placed respectfully but without candles, heavy frames or breakable objects within unsafe reach.
- No recording devices or personal phones aimed at children unless the media plan is active and consent confirmed.

## 11. Check-in and check-out

### Friday parent-present procedure

30. Parent or authorized guardian signs the child in, confirms presence on site and notes any same-day medical, emotional or pickup change.
31. Welcome volunteer marks the child in the age-zone roster and confirms media status using a discreet code; no public allergy or custody details.
32. Children transition as a group with screened adults after shared kīrtana or worship.
33. At the end of the child block, screened adults reunite children directly with their parent or hand them into the supervised family laboratory.
34. Formal dismissal occurs only after the parent acknowledges pickup. A child may not leave with another family based on a child's verbal statement.
35. Uncollected child remains with two screened adults while the Safety Lead contacts the parent and emergency contacts.

### Off-site procedure

- Written permission, current emergency data, transport assignment and authorized pickup list are completed before departure.
- Use a printed or offline-capable roster; do not rely solely on a phone with weak service.
- Issue buddy groups for headcount support, but buddies never replace adult supervision.
- No family may take a child from the site without notifying the trip lead and signing out.
- A missing-child response is rehearsed: stop movement, alert site security, assign search zones, contact parent and call emergency services promptly.

## 12. Incident documentation

### Four record types

| Record                   | Examples                                                                              | Timing                                                         |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Medical/injury report    | Fall, cut, allergic symptoms, head impact, first aid, emergency transport.            | Same day; immediate parent contact for more than trivial care. |
| Behavior/safety incident | Hitting, elopement, dangerous instrument use, repeated unsafe disruption.             | Same day; support review within seventy-two hours.             |
| Boundary concern         | Private message, secret, gift, inappropriate touch, one-to-one access, policy breach. | Immediate safety notification and access control.              |
| Near miss / hazard       | Unlocked exit, missing headcount, unlabelled food, unsafe transport substitution.     | Same day; preventive action assigned.                          |

### Incident form minimum fields

- Date, time, location, activity and adults present.
- Child or children involved; record identifiers rather than full data in broad-access systems.
- Objective sequence: what was observed, heard and done. Separate fact from interpretation.
- Injury or immediate risk, first aid and emergency action.
- Exact child words when relevant; do not paraphrase a disclosure into stronger or weaker language.
- Parent communication and any authority report reference handled in restricted records.
- Corrective/preventive action, owner and review date.
- Sign-off by Safety Lead or non-conflicted Deputy.

#### Record-storage rule

Incident, medical, clearance, contact, custody and mentor records do not belong in the Git repository or a broadly shared Drive folder. Use restricted storage with access logging and a retention schedule approved by counsel and the insurer.

## 13. Photography and media

### Consent choices must be granular

| Consent option                                | Default                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| No photography/video of child                 | Always available; no disadvantage to child.            |
| Internal closed family group                  | Opt in separately.                                     |
| Temple or KUTUMBA public website/social media | Separate explicit opt in.                              |
| Child's first name with image                 | Separate opt in; surname and school are not published. |
| Livestream or real-time location post         | Disabled at launch.                                    |

- Only a designated media volunteer uses an approved device during child activities. Other volunteers keep personal phones away.
- Before recording, the media volunteer checks the current roster; a colored lanyard or seating zone may indicate no-media status without labeling the child publicly.
- No images of toileting, changing, injury, distress, punishment, sleep, swimwear or a child in an embarrassing or vulnerable state.
- Do not publish full names, school, address, routine, exact live location, medical information or prayer requests that identify a child.
- Parents may withdraw future consent at any time. KUTUMBA removes controlled copies where practical but does not promise recall of material already copied by others; therefore distribution must be narrow from the beginning.
- Children, especially youth, are asked for assent even when a parent has consented. A child who says no is not pressured.

## 14. Transportation, carpools and outings

### Default transport model

Parents transport their own children. Parent-organized carpools are private family arrangements unless KUTUMBA assigns drivers, collects riders or represents the ride as program transport. Once KUTUMBA organizes it, the program must control the risk.

### KUTUMBA-organized transport requirements

36. Written parent consent naming the driver or approved driver pool and destination.
37. Driver is at least twenty-one, screened for the role, appropriately licensed, insured and using a roadworthy vehicle.
38. Every occupant has an individual seat belt. Pennsylvania child-restraint requirements are followed; KUTUMBA should keep children in the rear seat through age twelve as the safer internal standard.
39. No unrelated one-adult/one-child ride. Use another adult or multiple children, unless an immediate emergency makes delay more dangerous; document the exception.
40. No teen driver transports children for KUTUMBA.
41. No last-minute driver, vehicle or child-seat substitution without trip-lead and parent approval.
42. Vehicle manifest, departure and arrival check-ins, emergency contact, route and convoy/contact plan are maintained.
43. Drivers do not use phones while moving and do not make unscheduled stops except for safety.
44. Children are never left in a parked vehicle, even briefly.

### Outing risk review

- Site permission, weather, terrain, water, traffic, animals, crowds, food, toilets, accessibility, emergency signal and reunification point.
- For water activities, boating, kayaking, high heat, severe cold, climbing or overnight travel, obtain specialist review and separate written controls. These are not routine extensions of a Friday class.
- At farms and cow-protection sites, children follow handler instructions, remain outside restricted areas and do not feed or approach animals without permission.
- A festival or pilgrimage includes devotional purpose, conduct briefing, buddy/headcount plan and post-event reflection.

## 15. Medical, allergy and illness procedures

### Launch model: parents retain medication responsibility

- Parents remain on site and administer routine and rescue medication. This avoids creating an untrained medication-administration system.
- A child with a significant allergy, asthma, seizure condition or other emergency need has a concise written action plan supplied by the parent and, where appropriate, a clinician.
- Medication remains with the parent unless an off-site exception has been explicitly approved. It is labeled and never stored in a common child-accessible bin.
- At least two on-site adults hold current first-aid/CPR training. Training does not expand their role beyond competence or legal authorization.
- Call 911 for breathing difficulty, anaphylaxis, loss of consciousness, suspected serious head/neck injury, uncontrolled bleeding, seizure emergency or other serious condition. Do not wait for group consensus.
- After any head impact, allergic reaction, medication assistance or emergency call, complete an incident report and require parent follow-up.

## Food and allergy control

- Maintain an adult-only allergy summary and a separate detailed restricted record.
- Wednesday headcount confirms allergies; Friday dishes arrive with ingredient cards and preparation contact.
- No food sharing between children without parent approval. Children wash hands before food handling and eating.
- Use dedicated utensils and separate serving where cross-contact risk exists. “No onion/no garlic” is not an allergy-control system.
- A preparation that cannot be verified is not served to the child with the relevant allergy. Social pressure never overrides safety.
- Children with symptoms of contagious illness stay with parents and do not join the child zone; return follows current medical/public-health guidance rather than a made-up KUTUMBA rule.

## 16. Child mentor boundaries

KUTUMBA may use mentor families, but it should not create private adult–child spiritual mentorship. The mentor relationship is family-to-family and parent-visible.

- All digital communication with a minor includes the parent or occurs in an approved group channel. No disappearing messages, private social-media accounts or late-night conversation.
- No closed-door meetings, private home visits, hotel-room meetings, sleepovers, private rides or one-to-one outings.
- No requests for secrecy. Surprises may be time-limited and parent-approved; secrets about touch, gifts, rules or adult behavior are prohibited.
- No personal loans, significant gifts, exclusive favoritism, romanticized “special bond,” physical affection against the child’s preference or contact that would be inappropriate in public.
- Mentors do not provide therapy, marital mediation, confession, medical advice, diagnosis or independent initiation guidance.
- A mentor who hears a safety concern follows reporting procedures; confidentiality to the child is not promised.
- Mentor service is reviewed annually and ends immediately if boundaries cannot be maintained.

## 17. Support plans for rough or disruptive behavior

### Use a Regulation and Safety Plan, not a punishment contract

| Plan field              | Content                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Strengths and interests | What engages the child, preferred service, supportive relationships and successful conditions.                              |
| Known triggers          | Noise, waiting, hunger, transitions, competition, difficult text, touch, fatigue, sibling conflict or unclear instructions. |
| Early signs             | Pacing, loud voice, withdrawal, grabbing, joking escalation or refusal.                                                     |
| Preventive supports     | Visual schedule, movement job, preview, shorter task, choice, sensory protection, seat placement or parent proximity.       |
| Reset plan              | Where, with whom, how long, and how the child signals readiness to return.                                                  |
| Unsafe behaviors        | Specific observable actions that require immediate parent takeover or activity stop.                                        |
| Repair and re-entry     | Restore safety, make practical repair, review next step privately; no forced public apology.                                |
| Review                  | Date, parent input, child input where appropriate, data from incidents and staffing decision.                               |



## Response to rough behavior

45. Use a clear safety command: “Stop. Hands down. Step back.”
46. Move other children and dangerous objects before attempting discussion.
47. A trained adult may use the least physical intervention necessary to block immediate harm, but KUTUMBA does not authorize restraint as a behavior tool. Call emergency help when the risk exceeds training.
48. Parent takes over regulation. The child does not re-enter the same activity until the lead confirms safety.
49. Document the event, antecedents and supports. Do not circulate video or discuss the child in the family group.
50. After repeated incidents, decide whether added staffing, modified activity, parent-provided support or a temporary pause is required.

### Inclusion boundary

KUTUMBA should make reasonable practical accommodations and avoid stigmatizing disability or neurodivergence. It must also be honest about capacity. A volunteer program cannot safely promise one-to-one therapeutic support it does not have.

## 18. Teen leadership

Teen leadership is formation in service, not cheap staffing. Teens remain minors and are never made responsible for the safety, discipline or confidential care of younger children.

| Permitted supervised roles                                                                                                                                                               | Prohibited roles                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lead a three-minute review, demonstrate kartālas, prepare props, help a younger group with art, welcome families, support cleanup, track supplies, narrate drama, research a holy place. | Count as the second adult; be alone with a child; check children out; transport; administer medication; handle incident or medical records; manage discipline; receive private disclosures; privately message younger children. |

## Teen development sequence

51. Observe: watch a trained adult and identify preparation, safety and inclusion practices.
52. Assist: perform one bounded task with real-time supervision.
53. Prepare: submit a short plan using an approved source and materials list.
54. Facilitate: lead five to ten minutes while an adult remains responsible.
55. Reflect: receive feedback on reliability, humility, clarity and child inclusion.
56. Repeat: earn broader responsibility through consistency, not charisma.

## 19. Śloka, prayer and bhajana progression

### Curriculum-control rule

The exact pronunciation, tune, mantra sequence and worship use must be reviewed by the KUTUMBA Worship Lead and a qualified ISKCON authority. This document defines progression, not an independent ritual standard.

## First six months

| Cycle   | Core recitation                                                      | Meaning target                                                                            | Performance expectation                                                     |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cycle 1 | Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra; Śrīla Prabhupāda praṇāma; Bhagavad-gītā 2.13 | Identity beyond bodily change; gratitude to the founder-ācārya; attentive group response. | Group participation and meaning. Solo recitation optional.                  |
| Cycle 2 | Prasāda prayers; Bhagavad-gītā 2.22; review mahā-mantra              | Action, gratitude, changing bodies and respect for prasāda.                               | Children may use cue cards. Accuracy grows gradually.                       |
| Cycle 3 | Pañca-tattva mantra; Bhagavad-gītā 4.34; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24 | Mercy of Śrī Caitanya; safe and authorized guidance; breadth of bhakti.                   | Older children explain meaning; younger children identify pictures/actions. |

## Three-year progression

| Year   | Prayer/bhajana focus                                                                                              | Verse focus                                                                                                      |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Year 1 | Mahā-mantra, Prabhupāda praṇāma, Pañca-tattva, prasāda prayers, Nṛsiṃha prayers, Jaya Rādhā-Mādhava introduction. | Selected Bhagavad-gītā verses on soul, karma, Kṛṣṇa and guidance; Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24.                   |
| Year 2 | Tulasī prayers, selected Gurvāṣṭakam, Dāmodarāṣṭakam in season, approved āraṭi-response training.                 | Verses on qualities, mind, devotion and offering; selected Nectar of Instruction and Śrī Īśopaniṣad foundations. |
| Year 3 | Guru-vandanā, selected Vaiṣṇava bhajanas, Śikṣāṣṭakam progression and supervised kīrtana leadership.              | Study-ready set connected to Bhagavad-gītā structure, nāma, guru, service and surrender.                         |

## Memorization method

- Hear correct pronunciation and meaning before memorizing.
- Use short daily repetition, actions, call-and-response and visual chunking.
- Assess privately through participation, matching, paraphrase, cue-card recitation or voluntary solo recitation.
- Do not publicly rank speed, accent, memory or musical ability.
- A child may demonstrate understanding without perfect Sanskrit pronunciation; teachers still model accurate pronunciation patiently.

## 20. Arts, music, cooking and language modules

### Drama

Four-step cycle: understand source, choose one principle, rehearse cooperative roles, present briefly. Use narrators and non-speaking roles. No caricature of sacred persons, forced emotion or glamorizing demons/violence.

### Craft and visual art

Use art to recall meaning, not fill time. Avoid placing sacred names or images on disposable plates, floors or items likely to be discarded disrespectfully. Label the source/story.

**Kartālas**

Grip, open/closed stroke, steady pulse, response discipline, volume control and respectful storage. Children stop immediately on the leader's signal.

**Mṛdaṅga / tabla**

Only with a competent instructor. Teach posture, basic stroke, rhythm, listening and instrument care. Limit volume and duration; provide hearing/sensory alternatives.

**Singing and bhajana**

Approved repertoire, meaning, pronunciation, response etiquette and pitch comfort. No mocking voices or forcing solos.

**Cooking**

Handwashing, ingredient identification, allergy controls, no tasting before offering, age-safe tools, heat/knife boundaries, cleanup and offering culture. Young children assemble or wash; older children measure and prepare under direct supervision.

**Language**

Sanskrit/Bengali pronunciation, key vocabulary and Devanāgarī exposure where useful. Language supports understanding; it is not a status marker.

**Writing and journaling**

Older children keep short source/application notes. Journals are not private confessional documents for adults to read without a stated purpose and parent awareness.

**Six-week rotating enrichment pattern**

| Week | Enrichment                          |
|------|-------------------------------------|
| 1    | Storytelling and visual art         |
| 2    | Drama and movement                  |
| 3    | Kartāla / rhythm                    |
| 4    | Cooking or practical service        |
| 5    | Language / verse meaning            |
| 6    | Integrated presentation and cleanup |

## 21. Outdoor and pilgrimage education

**Outdoor learning objectives**

- Observe Kṛṣṇa's material energy with gratitude and curiosity rather than making unsupported scientific claims.
- Practise care for land, animals, shared property and other visitors.
- Build endurance, cooperation, attention and practical competence.
- Connect activity to hearing, chanting, remembrance or service so the event does not become ordinary recreation branded as spiritual.
- Learn risk awareness, preparation, weather judgment and leaving no trace.

## Pilgrimage progression

| Stage  | Child learning                                                                                                                            |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Before | Where are we going? Why is it sacred? Who served there? What conduct and safety rules apply?                                              |
| During | Hear one focused narration, perform one service, keep buddy/headcount practice, observe respectfully and avoid consumer-tourist behavior. |
| After  | Draw, journal or present: one place, one person, one teaching, one service and one home application.                                      |

- A picnic includes kīrtana, story, gratitude or service but does not require a lecture throughout the day.
- A japa walk uses routes appropriate for age, weather and traffic; adults remain able to hear and see children.
- Kayaking, swimming and boating are high-risk activities. They require qualified providers, personal flotation devices, water-specific ratios and insurance review; they are not approved by this general policy alone.
- At crowded festivals, use identifiable groups, fixed meeting points, phone-independent child instructions and frequent headcounts.

## 22. Material success, character and spiritual development

| Formation lane      | What KUTUMBA develops                                                                                                                         | What KUTUMBA avoids                                                                           |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Material competence | Study habits, time management, health, communication, financial responsibility, practical skills, resilience and responsible career thinking. | Calling education or work “material” as an excuse for laziness or poor duty.                  |
| Character           | Truthfulness, compassion, cleanliness, courage, self-control, reliability, gratitude, humility, repair and protection of others.              | Rewarding mere compliance, politeness theater or silence about harm.                          |
| Spiritual growth    | Hearing, chanting, remembrance, worship, service, association, inquiry and growing relationship with Kṛṣṇa.                                   | Measuring devotion by performance, clothing, accent, family status, emotion or public rounds. |

**Core message to children.** Success is not choosing between responsible worldly duty and devotion. The aim is to perform duty honestly, cultivate character and increasingly connect one’s abilities and results to Kṛṣṇa. Wealth, academic rank and prestige do not prove spiritual advancement; poverty, disorganization or failure do not prove detachment.

## 23. Evaluation without comparison

### Private growth profile

| Domain   | Evidence                                                                                    |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Know     | Can recall, retell, explain or cite an authorized source at the age-appropriate level.      |
| Practise | Participates in prayer, kīrtana, japa, worship or home practice with growing understanding. |
| Serve    | Completes age-appropriate service reliably and cares for materials, people and space.       |
| Relate   | Uses safe body, kind speech, inclusion, repair and help-seeking.                            |
| Reflect  | Can name a question, choice, challenge, lesson or next step honestly.                       |

| Domain | Evidence                                                                                             |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lead   | For older youth only: prepares, facilitates within limits, protects boundaries and accepts feedback. |

### Four developmental markers

- Introduced — has encountered the idea or skill.
- Developing — participates with prompts or models.
- Consistent with support — applies in familiar settings with occasional help.
- Increasingly independent — explains or performs reliably and knows when to seek guidance.

### Assessment methods

- Portfolio artifacts: drawing, story map, journal, service checklist, audio recorded only with consent, or photo of a project without identifying the child.
- Observation notes tied to a learning outcome, not personality judgment.
- Voluntary demonstration, paired recitation, group presentation or teaching-back.
- Child self-reflection using simple prompts: “I learned... I tried... I need help with...”
- Parent input on home practice without demanding proof or round counts.
- One private cycle report with a strength, next step and family support.

### What is never published

- Rankings, scores, leaderboards or “top devotee” awards.
- Children’s chanting rounds, family altar quality, donation, cooking quality, school grades or behavior charts.
- Public lists of who completed memorization, attended most often or performed best.
- Comparisons between siblings or families.

## 24. Required forms and records

| Form                              | Minimum content                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Child registration and profile    | Age, pronouncing name, parents/guardians, authorized pickup, interests, language, access needs and relevant support information.             |
| Emergency and medical form        | Contacts, allergies, emergency conditions, clinician plan where needed, insurance details if counsel recommends, consent for emergency care. |
| Media consent                     | Separate internal/public/name/livestream choices and child assent procedure.                                                                 |
| Transportation and outing consent | Destination, driver, vehicle, restraint, emergency plan and pickup.                                                                          |
| Volunteer application             | Identity, experience, references, prior concerns, philosophy of discipline, reporting understanding and consent to checks.                   |
| Volunteer code of conduct         | Two-adult, digital, touch, gifts, secrets, transport, reporting, confidentiality and self-disclosure rules.                                  |
| Training and clearance register   | Dates, expiration, role, reviewer and restrictions; clearance documents stored separately and confidentially.                                |
| Friday roster                     | Arrival, parent on site, child zone, media code, departure and unusual same-day note.                                                        |
| Incident / near-miss report       | Objective facts, response, communication, preventive action and restricted report references.                                                |
| Regulation and Safety Plan        | Strengths, triggers, supports, unsafe behaviors, parent role, re-entry and review date.                                                      |
| Teen sevā agreement               | Role, supervision, boundaries, parent consent and feedback.                                                                                  |

| Form                 | Minimum content                                                                                           |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Trip risk assessment | Site, weather, transport, headcount, medical, food, water, animals, communications and emergency actions. |

## Data separation

| May be in Git / curriculum repository                                                                      | Must remain in restricted operational storage                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Blank forms, policy, lesson plans, generic checklists, approved songs/verse references, training outlines. | Completed forms, contact lists, child profiles, medical/allergy details, custody restrictions, attendance, clearances, incident records, mentor notes and media-consent records. |

## 25. Launch gates and implementation sequence

### Hard launch gates

57. Local temple leadership understands the program and confirms the applicable child-protection relationship and reporting path.
58. Current North American ISKCON child-protection authority or designated local Child Protection Team reviews the safeguarding baseline.
59. Pennsylvania counsel or the insurer confirms whether the parent-present model triggers any child-care licensing, facility or insurance requirement. KUTUMBA does not advertise itself as legally exempt without written confirmation.
60. Child Safety Team of at least three screened adults is appointed and independent stop authority is documented.
61. Every designated child volunteer has complete screening, clearances, references, training and signed code.
62. At least two adults hold current first-aid/CPR training and the emergency/evacuation plan is practised.
63. The physical site passes a documented safety and visibility walkthrough.
64. Registration, emergency, allergy, media, behavior and incident forms are ready in restricted storage.
65. Parents complete orientation and sign the family covenant.
66. The first six weeks of child lessons and materials are complete before launch.

### Recommended implementation sequence

| Timing                   | Action                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8–10 weeks before launch | Appoint Safety Team; contact temple/CPO; begin legal and insurance review; lock parent-present boundary. |
| 6–8 weeks before         | Recruit and screen volunteers; submit clearances; select site; draft forms.                              |
| 4–6 weeks before         | Complete mandated-reporter, ISKCON and KUTUMBA training; run behavior and disclosure scenarios.          |
| 2–4 weeks before         | Site drill, check-in simulation, allergy/food simulation, lesson rehearsal and parent orientation.       |
| Launch month             | Use one visible hall, three screened adults, no off-site transport and no public child media.            |
| After Cycle 1            | Review incidents, staffing, age placement, lesson duration and parent burden before expanding.           |
| After six months         | Formal policy review; decide whether to add rooms, outings, mentors, public media or additional modules. |

**Recommendation**

Do not launch the children’s track merely because curriculum is ready. The critical path is safety leadership, screening, training, parent-present operations, restricted records and a current external review. A delayed safe launch is cheaper than improvising after an incident.

**Appendix A — Pennsylvania and ISKCON verification notes**

This appendix records the current sources reviewed as of 29 June 2026. It is a design aid, not legal advice. Laws, official processes and ISKCON structures can change; the launch team must verify them again before implementation.

**A1. ISKCON child-protection baseline**

- ISKCON’s published Child Protection Policy and Operational Guidelines state that child protection is paramount, require compliance with civil and ecclesiastical law, and require prompt reporting of concerns to relevant secular authorities where applicable.
- The published guidelines describe trained local Child Protection Teams, annual training for children and adults, local-law familiarity, screening of trusted volunteers, codes of practice and reporting to civil authorities and the CPO.
- The 2025 GBC strategy described a unified global policy, prevention-first local implementation, oversight and independent third-party investigations.
- A 2026 North American update confirms structural changes and reiterates that abuse allegations are reported first to local government authorities and/or law enforcement.
- Because implementation is evolving, KUTUMBA must obtain the current North American policy, reporting contacts and any local temple requirements rather than relying only on an older manual.

**A2. Pennsylvania volunteer clearances**

- Adults age eighteen or older in unpaid roles who are responsible for a child’s welfare or have direct volunteer contact with children are within the state clearance framework.
- The state identifies the Pennsylvania Child Abuse History Certification, Pennsylvania State Police Criminal History Record Check and, for applicable volunteers, DHS FBI fingerprint check or the statutory ten-year-residency written statement.
- Volunteer clearances are renewed every sixty months; organizations retain confidential copies. The state permits organizations to impose stricter selection standards.
- KUTUMBA’s recommended internal simplification is to require the FBI check for every designated direct-contact adult rather than administer residency exceptions.

**A3. Pennsylvania mandated reporting**

- Pennsylvania lists clergy and paid or unpaid individuals who are integral to a regularly scheduled program and have direct contact with children or responsibility for their welfare as mandated reporters.
- A mandated reporter with reasonable cause to suspect child abuse reports through ChildLine or the Child Welfare Portal. The direct report is not replaced by telling a supervisor.
- ChildLine: 1-800-932-0313. Immediate danger: 911.
- KUTUMBA should train all designated child volunteers to the mandated-reporter standard rather than trying to make case-by-case assumptions about who is technically covered.

#### A4. Pennsylvania transport requirements

- PennDOT states that children under two remain rear-facing until manufacturer limits, children under four use an approved child safety seat, children ages four through seven use a booster and children age eight and older use a seat belt.
- PennDOT recommends children remain in the rear seat through age twelve. KUTUMBA should adopt this recommendation as its internal transport standard.

#### A5. Child-care licensing uncertainty

Pennsylvania regulates facilities providing child care to unrelated children and defines child care around care in lieu of parental care. The sources reviewed do not provide a clear, specific ruling for KUTUMBA's exact model: parents are on site but children separate for a structured forty-minute religious-education block. Therefore:

- Keep parents on site and expressly responsible during the pilot.
- Do not provide drop-off attendance, routine nursery care or paid child-care claims.
- Obtain written clarification from Pennsylvania counsel, the DHS regional child-development office or the insurer before changing the model.
- Do not rely on a general "place of worship" exemption without review; the statutory language and applicability can be narrower than casual assumptions.

## Appendix B — Source list

- **KUTUMBA Master Operating Model (internal project source)**  
Attached project document, reviewed 29 June 2026.
- **ISKCON GBC — New Child Protection Policies Approved by ISKCON Authorities**  
<https://gbc.iskcon.org/new-child-protection-policies-approved-by-iskcon-authorities/>
- **ISKCON Child Protection Policy and Operational Guidelines**  
<https://safetemple.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/04/ISKCON-Child-Protection-Policy-and-Operational-Guidelines-English.pdf>
- **ISKCON News — Enhanced Child Protection Strategy, January 2025**  
<https://iskconnews.org/january-3rd-gbc-meeting-report-enhanced-child-protection-strategy-unveiled-and-leadership-updates/>
- **ISKCON News — North American Child Protection Office update, April 2026**  
<https://iskconnews.org/update-on-iskcon-child-protection-o%EF%AC%83ce-in-north-america-released-by-na-rgb/>
- **Pennsylvania DHS — Child Abuse Clearances**  
<https://www.pa.gov/agencies/dhs/resources/keep-kids-safe/child-abuse-clearances>
- **Pennsylvania DHS — Volunteers FAQ, 23 August 2024**  
[https://www.pa.gov/content/dam/copapwp-pagov/en/dhs/documents/keepkidssafe/clearances/documents/kks-volunteers-faq\\_2024-08-23.pdf](https://www.pa.gov/content/dam/copapwp-pagov/en/dhs/documents/keepkidssafe/clearances/documents/kks-volunteers-faq_2024-08-23.pdf)
- **Pennsylvania DHS — Report Child Abuse or Neglect as a Mandated Reporter**  
<https://www.pa.gov/services/dhs/report-child-abuse-or-neglect-as-a-mandated-reporter>
- **PennDOT — Child Passenger Safety**  
<https://www.pa.gov/agencies/penndot/traveling-in-pa/safety/traffic-safety-driver-topics/child-passenger-safety>
- **Pennsylvania DHS — Child Care Regulations**  
<https://www.pa.gov/agencies/dhs/resources/for-providers/child-care-for-providers/child-care-regulations>



## Source hierarchy for child lessons

- Primary: Śrīla Prabhupāda's Bhagavad-gītā As It Is, Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Kṛṣṇa Book, Nectar of Devotion, Nectar of Instruction and Śrī Īsopaniṣad.
- Supporting: approved ISKCON child-education materials and biographies consistent with the primary sources.
- Operational safety: current law, official government guidance, current ISKCON child-protection policy and qualified professional advice.
- Teachers may simplify language and examples, but may not manufacture philosophy, speculate about another person's karma, invent worship procedures or use unreviewed internet devotional content.

## Approval record

| Reviewer | Role                                           | Decision / conditions | Date |
|----------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|------|
|          | KUTUMBA Program Director                       |                       |      |
|          | Children and Safety Lead                       |                       |      |
|          | Curriculum and Philosophy Lead                 |                       |      |
|          | Local temple representative                    |                       |      |
|          | Current ISKCON child-protection representative |                       |      |
|          | Pennsylvania counsel / insurer                 |                       |      |

*End of document*